

HOW TO BUY A TV

DON'T LET YOURSELF GET INTIMIDATED BY A LONG LAUNDRY LIST OF ACRONYMS AND TV JARGON. SIT BACK AND RELAX AS WE SHOW YOU HOW TO GO ABOUT MAKING AN INFORMED CHOICE WHEN IT COMES TO TELVISIONS

BY SOHAM RANINGA

Upgrading to a bigger screen TV is perhaps the most common temptation that most of us face this Diwali. The constant bombardment of offers along with newer, better models makes it almost impossible to ignore the lure to buy a new TV. I certainly succumbed to it and here's my advice on how to go about the buying process.

Assuming you are already aware of the bigger picture in terms of display types, resolution options and features on offer, your buying process will largely boil down to three factors apart from your budget – the screen size, smart TV or standard TV and of course the 4K dilemma. Let's start with the first and the most important factor – the screen size.

SCREEN SIZE MATTERS, MATTERS THE MOST

The golden rule to buying a new TV is to get the largest possible screen for your budget and viewing distance (more on viewing distance later). The sheer impact of a bigger screen will overshadow all finer elements and enhancements combined together. Having said that, the

compromises you make shouldn't sway heavily towards the image quality aspect of the TV. Coming back to the screen size, I suggest going one step further than your original plan, assuming you plan to upgrade from a 32-inch LCD TV to a 42-inch LED TV, you should ideally move a notch higher and get yourself a 48-inch or 50-inch LED panel. The same logic would apply as you move higher unless

you already own a 65-inch TV, in which case you should be considering buying a home theatre projector next.

SCREEN-SIZE VS VIEWING DISTANCE

The viewing distance for a TV comes into play once you move beyond the 42-inch screen size. Viewing distance is primarily governed by the content resolution and



Unless you live in a matchbox, bigger is better when it comes to screen size